

Acme Tech Solutions: Remote Work Policy

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Last Updated: July 1, 2026

Policy Owner: Human Resources Department (HR@acmetech.com)

Applies To: All full-time and part-time employees of Acme Tech Solutions ("the Company"). Contractors and temporary staff are excluded unless explicitly stated in their contracts.

1. Purpose and Scope

Acme Tech Solutions recognizes the value of flexible work arrangements in promoting work-life balance, increasing productivity, and reducing our environmental footprint. This policy outlines the guidelines, expectations, and procedures for remote work (telecommuting) to ensure consistent and fair application across the organization while maintaining operational efficiency and data security.

This policy supersedes all previous remote work agreements and guidelines. It is designed to be a living document, subject to review and modification based on business needs and employee feedback.

2. Definitions

- **Remote Work:** Working from a location other than the primary Acme Tech Solutions office (e.g., home office, co-working space) for a portion or all of an employee's scheduled work hours.
- **Hybrid Work:** A schedule that combines working from the Company office and working remotely.
- **Fully Remote:** Working exclusively from a remote location, rarely or never required to be physically present at the Company office.
- **Core Hours:** The designated hours during which all employees, regardless of location, are expected to be online and available for meetings and collaboration.

3. Eligibility and Approval

Not all roles at Acme Tech Solutions are suitable for remote work. Eligibility is determined by the nature of the job responsibilities, the employee's performance record, and team requirements.

3.1 Assessing Suitability

Managers will evaluate remote work requests based on the following criteria:

- **Nature of Work:** Can the duties be performed effectively off-site? Does the role require constant physical presence or access to specialized on-site equipment?
- **Performance:** Does the employee have a track record of meeting performance expectations, working independently, and managing time effectively? Employees on Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs) are generally not eligible for remote work.
- **Communication:** Does the employee demonstrate strong written and verbal communication skills necessary for remote collaboration?
- **Operational Needs:** Will the remote arrangement negatively impact team coverage, client service, or overall business operations?

3.2 Request Process

1. Employees interested in a remote or hybrid work arrangement must submit a formal request via the HR portal (Workday) at least four (4) weeks in advance of the desired start date.
2. The direct manager will review the request and schedule a meeting to discuss the proposed arrangement, including specific days, hours, and communication expectations.
3. Final approval requires sign-off from both the direct manager and the Department Head.
4. Approved arrangements will be documented in a Remote Work Agreement, signed by the employee and manager.

4. Work Environment and Equipment

Employees working remotely are responsible for maintaining a safe, ergonomic, and distraction-free work environment.

4.1 Home Office Setup

- **Dedicated Space:** Employees should designate a specific area for work that minimizes interruptions and maintains a professional appearance during video calls.
- **Internet Connectivity:** A reliable, high-speed internet connection is mandatory. The Company will provide a monthly stipend of \$50 to subsidize internet costs.
- **Health and Safety:** Employees are expected to ensure their remote workspace complies with basic health and safety standards. The Company is not liable for injuries occurring in the remote workspace unless directly related to the performance of job duties.

4.2 Company-Provided Equipment

Acme Tech Solutions will provide the necessary equipment for employees to perform their duties remotely. This typically includes:

- One (1) company-issued laptop.
- Standard software licenses and security tools (VPN, endpoint protection).

Employees may request additional equipment (e.g., monitor, keyboard, ergonomic chair) up to a maximum value of \$500, subject to manager approval. All company-provided equipment

remains the property of Acme Tech Solutions and must be returned upon termination of employment or the remote work agreement.

4.3 Use and Maintenance

Employees must use company-provided equipment solely for business purposes and adhere to the Acceptable Use of Technology Policy. Any loss, damage, or theft of company equipment must be reported immediately to the IT Helpdesk (ITHelp@acmetech.com).

5. Security and Confidentiality

Maintaining data security is paramount in a remote work environment. Employees must strictly adhere to the Company's Data Security and Privacy Policies.

5.1 Protecting Company Information

- **VPN Requirement:** All remote access to the Company network and internal systems must be conducted through the approved Virtual Private Network (VPN).
- **Device Security:** Company laptops must be locked when unattended. Employees must not allow unauthorized individuals (including family members) to use company devices.
- **Physical Security:** Printed documents containing sensitive or confidential information must be stored securely and shredded when no longer needed.
- **Public Wi-Fi:** Working from public locations (e.g., cafes) using unsecured Wi-Fi networks is strictly prohibited when accessing sensitive company data. If necessary, employees must use a secure mobile hotspot or the company VPN.

5.2 Incident Reporting

Any suspected security breach, data loss, or unauthorized access must be reported immediately to the Information Security Officer (Infosec@acmetech.com) within 1 hour of discovery.

6. Communication and Availability

Effective communication is critical for remote teams. Employees must remain accessible and responsive during their scheduled work hours.

6.1 Core Hours

Acme Tech Solutions operates with Core Hours from 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM (Local Time). All employees, regardless of their specific work schedule or location, must be online and available for synchronous communication and meetings during this time.

6.2 Communication Protocols

- **Calendar Management:** Employees must keep their calendars up-to-date, reflecting their working hours, breaks, and out-of-office status.

- **Responsiveness:** Employees are expected to respond to urgent communications (direct messages, urgent emails) within 1 hour during their scheduled working hours. Non-urgent communications should be addressed within 24 hours.
- **Video Conferencing:** For internal and external meetings, employees are encouraged to keep their cameras on to foster engagement and connection.
- **Status Updates:** Regular communication with managers regarding project progress and any roadblocks is essential. The frequency and format of these updates will be determined by individual teams.

7. Performance and Evaluation

Remote work does not change the expectations for employee performance.

- Performance will be evaluated based on the achievement of goals, quality of work, and adherence to company values, rather than physical presence.
- Managers will conduct regular check-ins and formal performance reviews as outlined in the Performance Management Policy.
- If a remote work arrangement negatively impacts an employee's performance or team dynamics, the Company reserves the right to modify or terminate the agreement with a minimum of two (2) weeks' notice, requiring the employee to return to the office.

8. Time Tracking and Overtime

- **Non-Exempt Employees:** Hourly employees must accurately track and report all hours worked using the company's designated timekeeping system (Kronos). Any overtime must be pre-approved in writing by the direct manager. Working off-the-clock is strictly prohibited.
- **Exempt Employees:** Salaried employees are expected to manage their time to fulfill their responsibilities, generally working a standard 40-hour week. While formal time tracking is not required, consistent availability during Core Hours is mandatory.

9. Policy Review and Compliance

This policy will be reviewed annually by the HR Department. Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of the remote work agreement or employment. Employees with questions regarding this policy should contact their HR Business Partner.

Acknowledgment:

By submitting a remote work request or participating in a remote work arrangement, employees acknowledge they have read, understood, and agree to abide by the terms of this policy.